

insight ■ troubleshooting

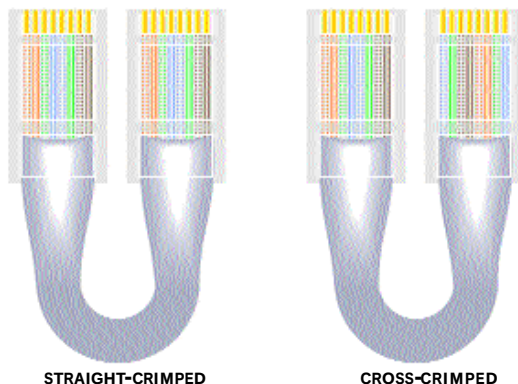
Networking two PCs

Q. I have two computers and two network cards. Is it possible to connect them without modems or hubs?

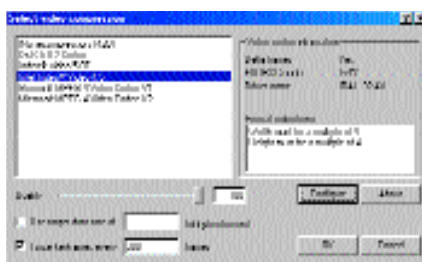
Sawma Lunglei

Via e-mail

A To be able to connect two PCs directly using LAN cards, you will have to use a cross-crimped network cable—it's not as complicated as it sounds. All network cables are made of four pairs of wires, connected to RJ45 connectors. For a standard network, you would ensure that the colours of the wires at both ends are in the exact same sequence. For a direct PC-to-PC network, one pair of wires on



one connector would be in the opposite direction to the wires at the other end. You can have such a cable made by any hardware engineer. Just plug this into the network cards and your network will be up.



Choose the codec for the captured video

Outlook password

Q. Whenever I start Outlook, it opens my account by default. How can I protect Outlook with a password so that every time it is launched, it asks for authentication?

Gaurav

Via e-mail

A In Outlook, you can protect the data file with a password. To set the password, click **File > Data File Management > Settings > Change Password**. Enter the password and disable 'Save this password in your password list'. Now every time you open Outlook, you will be asked for this password, without which Outlook will not load the message store.

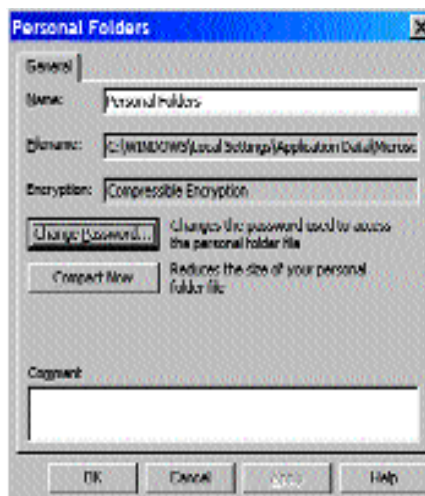
Virulent PC

Q. I have a Celeron-based computer with Windows 98 SE. My computer is infected with the VBS/Redlof virus. I use AVG anti-virus with the latest updates, but it cannot remove the virus. Please provide a remedy for this.

Dinesh

Via e-mail

A VBS/Redlof is a VBScript virus that infects HTM, HTML, ASP, PHP, JSP, HTT and VBS files by appending a script that contains an encrypted copy of the virus



Protect your e-mail in Outlook

code. Viewing an infected HTML document activates the virus. It usually targets the file folder.htt (used as a template for viewing folders as Web pages) stored as a hidden file in the Web folder under Windows. It will also be copied to kjwall.gif in the same directory. Like many of the worms found today, it propagates via e-mail by infecting blank.htm, the default stationery file for Microsoft Outlook or Outlook Express. The registry is edited to ensure that the infected user includes this default stationery file when composing e-mail. An infected VBScript

is copied to the System folder as nel.dll or kernel32.dll. Microsoft issued a security patch, which se against such vulnerability <http://www.microsoft.com/technet/security/MS00-075.asp>.

To remove the virus, first delete Temporary Internet Files **Control Panel > Internet Options** and click Delete. Next, delete the following registry for each user who ran the virus:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Identity\<Id>\Software\Microsoft\Outlook Express\<Version>\Mail\Compos Stationery

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Identity\<Id>\Software\Microsoft\Outlook Express\<Version>\Mail\Station Name

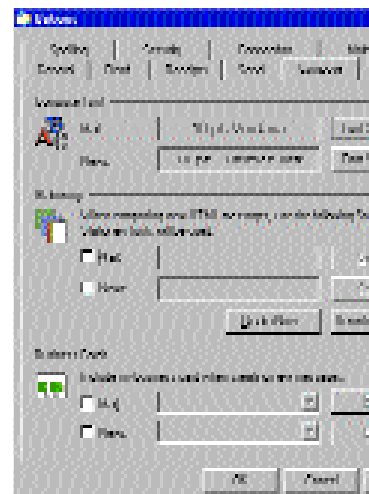
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Identity\<Id>\Software\Microsoft\Outlook Express\<Version>\Mail\WideStation Name

You should check all the identities present and all versions of Outlook for each user, a registry key HKEY_USERS stores their personal information. For each user, locate the following keys and delete them:

HKEY_USERS\<id>\Software\Microsoft\Windows Messaging Subsystem\Files\Microsoft Outlook Internet Settings\0a0d020000000000c00000000046\001e0360

HKEY_USERS\<id>\Software\Microsoft\Windows NT\Current Version\Windows Messaging Subsystem\Profile\Microsoft Outlook Internet Settings\0a0d020000000000c000000000001e0360

HKEY_USERS\<id>\Software\Microsoft\Windows NT\Current Version\Windows Messaging Subsystem\Profile\Microsoft Outlook Internet Settings\0a0d020000000000c000000000001e0360



Prevent infected stationery from being used in e-mail